SELF-HELP

Criticism Doesn't Work

Criticism makes people defend themselves; asking and explaining the reason is what actually changes behaviour.



How to Win Friends and Influence People
by Dale Carnegie



THE BIG IDEA

Criticising people is of no use. Ask, and explain why it's good for them, and they change on their own.

3 IDEAS AT A GLANCE

The ideas in this learning



01

Criticism makes people defensive



02

Orders only work while you're watching



03

Ask first, then explain the why

CONCEPT 1 OF 3

Criticism makes people defensive

It's human nature: when you criticise someone, they either **criticise you back** or say they couldn't have done any better. They never simply accept it, so criticism doesn't work.



CONCEPT 2 OF 3

Orders only work while you're watching

Giving orders with authority gets people to agree on the spot, but they don't really accept it. As soon as you're gone, they go back to what they were doing.



IN PRACTICE

An engineer **ordered** workers to wear their safety hats. They slowly agreed while he was there, but took the hats off as soon as he left.

CONCEPT 3 OF 3

Ask first, then explain the why

Instead of ordering, start with a question and show how the change helps **them**. People follow a rule they understand and agree with.



IN PRACTICE

The engineer changed his approach. When he saw a worker without a hat, he asked if the hat was uncomfortable and explained it was made for their safety. Far more workers started following the rule.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

What to remember

- Criticism makes people defend themselves instead of changing
- Authority gets agreement only while you're watching
- Ask a question before pointing out what's wrong
- Explain why the change is good for them

ACTION PLAN

Put it into practice

1. Catch myself before I criticise someone
2. Start with a question instead of an order
3. Explain how the change helps the other person



IN ONE LINE

Criticism makes people defend themselves; asking and explaining the reason is what actually changes behaviour.

#people-skills #communication #criticism #persuasion